

ZERO-TO-JOB-READY

DATA ANALYST 2026

M11 - PORTFOLIO, CAPSTONE & HIRING

Competence -> visible proof -> independent capstone -> truthful applications -> interview defense

PROVE IT -> PUBLISH IT -> EXPLAIN IT -> APPLY -> IMPROVE

Never publish or claim what you cannot validate and defend.

This book is your teacher

- M11 turns the skills from M00-M10 into hiring evidence. It is not a collection of motivational notes.
- Every PCH lesson has one direct worksheet plus a named companion artifact. You never need to guess which file to open.
- Course projects are projects, not employment. Resume/profile/application claims must remain truthful and traceable to evidence.
- The MarketPulse capstone is independent. Protected review checks quality/validation/rubric controls but does not reveal one 'winning dashboard'.
- Job-readiness Gate A is the normal final content Gate. A clean pass ends M11; B/C exist only for remediation after failure.
- Apply while improving. Interview/application errors become fresh drills instead of reasons to restart the whole course.

Normal M11 loop

1. Open direct PCH worksheet
2. Build real artifact
3. Validate/public-safety check
4. Save evidence
5. Protected review if needed
6. Close review
7. Changed retry
8. Update readiness/application funnel

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Module prerequisite and artifact map

0. Prerequisite

M00-M10 competency. M11 assumes you can perform analyst work but teaches from first principles how to package, prove, explain and apply that work. No prior job-search expertise is assumed.

- C1_M11_PORTFOLIO_CAPSTONE_HIRING_CANONICAL_PRACTICE_WORKBOOK_RC1.xlsx - direct PCH1-PCH14 routing.
- C1_M11_PORTFOLIO_BUILDER_RC1.xlsx + GitHub templates - portfolio/repository proof.
- C1_M11_MARKETPULSE_FINAL_CAPSTONE_RC1.xlsx + capstone rubric/review - independent final project.
- C1_M11_JUNIOR_DATA_ANALYST_RESUME_TEMPLATE_RC1.docx + resume/profile checklist.
- C1_M11_JOB_APPLICATION_TRACKER_RC1.xlsx + interview/hiring handbook.
- Job Readiness Gate A ParcelFlow; B RenewNow; C CareOps with separate protected reviews.

Truth / public-safety rule

- No fake employment, clients, certifications, competing offers or metrics.
- No private/confidential data, credentials or secrets in public repositories.
- Every quantified claim must have a reproducible evidence path.
- A course project may be strong evidence when it is labelled honestly as a project.

Exact practice, capstone and Gate route

- PCH1-PCH5 build portfolio/repository proof. PCH6 runs the independent MarketPulse capstone.
- PCH7-PCH8 build truthful resume/profile. PCH9 runs the application funnel.
- PCH10-PCH12 prepare project, technical and behavioral interviews. PCH13 handles offers/salary/logistics.
- PCH14 maintains the evidence-based readiness board and weekly repair plan.
- Then attempt Job Readiness Gate A. A clean pass ends M11 content competency. Gate B/C are remediation-only after prior failure + saved attempt + review + targeted repair + explicit assignment.

Critical failures

Invented experience/offer; material technical error not corrected; broken denominator/grain;
unsupported causal claim; inability to explain own portfolio; misleading application statement;
or publishing private/secrets can block a pass regardless of average quality.

PCH1 - What a fresher portfolio must prove

Open exactly: PCH1_Portfolio_Proof in C1_M11_PORTFOLIO_CAPSTONE_HIRING_CANONICAL_PRACTICE_WORKBOOK_RC1.xlsx

1. Why this lesson matters

A fresher portfolio must prove business framing, correct tool use, validation, communication and independent work. A small project with transparent decisions and checks is stronger than a polished screenshot with no evidence chain.

2. What you are learning

Map every hiring claim to inspectable evidence.

3. What you already need / prerequisite

M00-M10 technical/business evidence.

4. Picture it in your head

A portfolio is a proof cabinet. Each shelf should answer a recruiter question: Can this person frame a problem, work with data correctly, validate it, communicate it, and explain what they personally did?

5. New words before we use them

Evidence = inspectable proof. Artifact = file/repo/report/workbook. Defensible = you can explain choices and checks. Independent work = you made key decisions without copying a tutorial answer.

6. Watch / visual source

BOOK-LED. No external video is required. The learner book + PCH1_Portfolio_Proof + named companion artifact fully teach this competency.

PCH1 - Follow with me once

7. Follow with me once - fully worked teacher demonstration

Take one existing project. Write six evidence categories: framing, data quality/grain, tool/method, validation, communication, independent work. Under each, add the exact file/link proving it. Delete any unsupported skill claim.

8. What you should see / be able to say

You can show the artifact, point to its evidence/validation path, explain what you personally did, and state one limitation without hiding behind a tutorial or generic claim.

9. Why it worked

The hiring artifact is tied to real course/project evidence, separates fact from claim, and can be inspected by another person. That converts competence into visible proof rather than self-description.

10. Common beginner mistakes

Counting screenshots as evidence; polished dashboard with no validation; skill claimed without artifact; tutorial copy presented as independent work.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

1) Name the artifact/claim. 2) Ask what evidence would prove it. 3) Open the exact workbook/repo/template. 4) Validate the earliest weak link. 5) Remove unsupported wording rather than decorating it. 6) Open protected review only after saving the attempt.

PCH1 - Do alone, validate and master

12. Now you do a small version alone

Use a different project and rebuild the evidence map without copying the first one.

13. Validate your result

Check truthfulness, evidence path, public-safety/privacy, working links/files, metric/technical correctness where applicable, and whether a reviewer can understand it without private explanation.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain what this artifact proves, what it does not prove, one choice you personally made, one validation check and the next improvement.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Save the PCH1 artifact first. If repair is needed, open the protected PCH1 review, diagnose the weak hiring-evidence competency, close it, then complete the changed task. Keep both attempts.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Save the completed PCH1_Portfolio_Proof evidence row plus companion artifact/path. PASS -> PCH2. PARTIAL/FAIL -> targeted repair + changed retry before moving on.

PCH2 - Choose projects with different business stories

Open exactly: PCH2_Project_Selection in C1_M11_PORTFOLIO_CAPSTONE_HIRING_CANONICAL_PRACTICE_WORKBOOK_RC1.xlsx

1. Why this lesson matters

Choose projects that differ in business question, data structure and analytical method. A recruiter should see range: performance/operations, retention/cohort, and service/customer experience are useful contrasts.

2. What you are learning

Choose a small set of projects that prove different business/analytical abilities.

3. What you already need / prerequisite

Prerequisite: PCH1 evidence plus relevant earlier course artifacts.

4. Picture it in your head

Think like a film trailer editor: three projects should show different stories, not the same scene with different colors. Range comes from business problem/data/method, not forcing every tool into every project.

5. New words before we use them

Portfolio range = different business stories/methods. Redundancy = projects proving the same thing. Tool stuffing = adding tools only to list them. Selection rationale = why a project earns a slot.

6. Watch / visual source

BOOK-LED. No external video is required. The learner book + PCH2_Project_Selection + named companion artifact fully teach this competency.

PCH2 - Follow with me once

7. Follow with me once - fully worked teacher demonstration

Compare three candidate projects. Keep one operations/performance project, one retention/cohort project and one service/customer-experience project when they genuinely differ. For each, write the unique decision, grain and primary method.

8. What you should see / be able to say

You can show the artifact, point to its evidence/validation path, explain what you personally did, and state one limitation without hiding behind a tutorial or generic claim.

9. Why it worked

The hiring artifact is tied to real course/project evidence, separates fact from claim, and can be inspected by another person. That converts competence into visible proof rather than self-description.

10. Common beginner mistakes

Three near-identical sales dashboards; tool stuffing; selecting project because it looks pretty; no reason each project proves something different.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

1) Name the artifact/claim. 2) Ask what evidence would prove it. 3) Open the exact workbook/repo/template. 4) Validate the earliest weak link. 5) Remove unsupported wording rather than decorating it. 6) Open protected review only after saving the attempt.

PCH2 - Do alone, validate and master

12. Now you do a small version alone

Replace one selected project with a changed candidate and defend whether portfolio range improves.

13. Validate your result

Check truthfulness, evidence path, public-safety/privacy, working links/files, metric/technical correctness where applicable, and whether a reviewer can understand it without private explanation.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain what this artifact proves, what it does not prove, one choice you personally made, one validation check and the next improvement.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Save the PCH2 artifact first. If repair is needed, open the protected PCH2 review, diagnose the weak hiring-evidence competency, close it, then complete the changed task. Keep both attempts.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Save the completed PCH2_Project_Selection evidence row plus companion artifact/path. PASS -> PCH3. PARTIAL/FAIL -> targeted repair + changed retry before moving on.

PCH3 - Build a GitHub project repository recruiters can inspect

Open exactly: PCH3_Repo_Audit in C1_M11_PORTFOLIO_CAPSTONE_HIRING_CANONICAL_PRACTICE_WORKBOOK_RC1.xlsx

1. Why this lesson matters

A recruiter should be able to open a repository and understand the problem, files, method, validation and result without asking you to explain the folder structure. Keep raw data, prepared outputs and documentation clearly separated.

2. What you are learning

Build a recruiter-readable, public-safe GitHub repository.

3. What you already need / prerequisite

Prerequisite: PCH2 evidence plus relevant earlier course artifacts.

4. Picture it in your head

A repository is a self-guided museum. The visitor should know what to open first, what every folder contains, which file proves the result, and how to reproduce it without messaging you.

5. New words before we use them

Repository = versioned project folder on GitHub. README = landing-page documentation. Reproducibility = another person can rerun/open in stated order. Public-safe = contains no secret/private/unapproved data.

6. Watch / visual source

CURRENT_OFFICIAL_REFERENCE. GitHub Docs - Managing your profile README | Current profile README requirements and setup. Why: Use current GitHub mechanics; the course controls the portfolio evidence standard. Internal fallback: PCH3 learner lesson + repo audit + templates. Additional current reference: GitHub Docs - About READMEs.

[Open 1](#)

[Open 2](#)

PCH3 - Follow with me once

7. Follow with me once - fully worked teacher demonstration

Use a simple repo tree: README.md; data/README.md; analysis code/query/workbook; validation/; images/ only when useful; walkthrough.md. Open the repo as if you were a recruiter and remove anything unexplained or unsafe.

8. What you should see / be able to say

You can show the artifact, point to its evidence/validation path, explain what you personally did, and state one limitation without hiding behind a tutorial or generic claim.

9. Why it worked

The hiring artifact is tied to real course/project evidence, separates fact from claim, and can be inspected by another person. That converts competence into visible proof rather than self-description.

10. Common beginner mistakes

Repo opens with unexplained files; README link broken; raw/private data published; no validation folder; recruiter must guess run order.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

1) Name the artifact/claim. 2) Ask what evidence would prove it. 3) Open the exact workbook/repo/template. 4) Validate the earliest weak link. 5) Remove unsupported wording rather than decorating it. 6) Open protected review only after saving the attempt.

PCH3 - Do alone, validate and master

12. Now you do a small version alone

Audit a changed repository/folder tree and identify three changes before public sharing.

13. Validate your result

Check truthfulness, evidence path, public-safety/privacy, working links/files, metric/technical correctness where applicable, and whether a reviewer can understand it without private explanation.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain what this artifact proves, what it does not prove, one choice you personally made, one validation check and the next improvement.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Save the PCH3 artifact first. If repair is needed, open the protected PCH3 review, diagnose the weak hiring-evidence competency, close it, then complete the changed task. Keep both attempts.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Save the completed PCH3_Repo_Audit evidence row plus companion artifact/path. PASS -> PCH4. PARTIAL/FAIL -> targeted repair + changed retry before moving on.

PCH4 - Write the project README as a business case

Open exactly: PCH4_README in C1_M11_PORTFOLIO_CAPSTONE_HIRING_CANONICAL_PRACTICE_WORKBOOK_RC1.xlsx

1. Why this lesson matters

A README is a business case, not a diary. Start with the decision/problem, then data/grain, method, validation, findings, recommendation, limitations and reproducibility steps.

2. What you are learning

Write a project README as a decision-focused business case.

3. What you already need / prerequisite

Prerequisite: PCH3 evidence plus relevant earlier course artifacts.

4. Picture it in your head

A README is the project's case brief: decision first, then data/grain, quality, method, validation, findings, recommendation and limitations. It is not a diary of what you learned.

5. New words before we use them

Business case = decision-focused narrative. Grain = what one row represents. Validation = independent proof. Finding = evidence with comparison/magnitude. Limitation = what data/design cannot establish.

6. Watch / visual source

ASSIGNED_VISUAL. Alex The Analyst - Data Analyst Portfolio Project | SQL Data Exploration | 13:40-1:18:00; GitHub at 1:13:35. Why: See a real analysis-to-GitHub workflow, then use the stricter course README/evidence standard. Internal fallback: PCH4 learner book + PROJECT_README_TEMPLATE.md.

[Open 1](#)

PCH4 - Follow with me once

7. Follow with me once - fully worked teacher demonstration

Write README in this order: business decision -> data/grain/definitions -> quality -> method -> validation -> findings with magnitude -> recommendation -> limitations -> reproduce -> what I personally built.

8. What you should see / be able to say

You can show the artifact, point to its evidence/validation path, explain what you personally did, and state one limitation without hiding behind a tutorial or generic claim.

9. Why it worked

The hiring artifact is tied to real course/project evidence, separates fact from claim, and can be inspected by another person. That converts competence into visible proof rather than self-description.

10. Common beginner mistakes

README starts with 'I learned SQL'; missing grain/definition; findings have no magnitude; recommendation not traceable; reproduce steps missing.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

1) Name the artifact/claim. 2) Ask what evidence would prove it. 3) Open the exact workbook/repo/template. 4) Validate the earliest weak link. 5) Remove unsupported wording rather than decorating it. 6) Open protected review only after saving the attempt.

PCH4 - Do alone, validate and master

12. Now you do a small version alone

Write the opening, validation and limitation sections for a changed project README.

13. Validate your result

Check truthfulness, evidence path, public-safety/privacy, working links/files, metric/technical correctness where applicable, and whether a reviewer can understand it without private explanation.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain what this artifact proves, what it does not prove, one choice you personally made, one validation check and the next improvement.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Save the PCH4 artifact first. If repair is needed, open the protected PCH4 review, diagnose the weak hiring-evidence competency, close it, then complete the changed task. Keep both attempts.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Save the completed PCH4_README evidence row plus companion artifact/path. PASS -> PCH5. PARTIAL/FAIL -> targeted repair + changed retry before moving on.

PCH5 - Project validation before publishing

Open exactly: PCH5_Publication_QA in C1_M11_PORTFOLIO_CAPSTONE_HIRING_CANONICAL_PRACTICE_WORKBOOK_RC1.xlsx

1. Why this lesson matters

Before publishing, reconcile important metrics, inspect joins/cardinality, verify source-to-chart consistency, check that screenshots match current files, remove secrets/private data and challenge every claim in the README.

2. What you are learning

Run release QA before publishing a project.

3. What you already need / prerequisite

Prerequisite: PCH4 evidence plus relevant earlier course artifacts.

4. Picture it in your head

Publishing is a release gate. Before a project becomes evidence, challenge links, row counts, joins, numbers, screenshots, privacy and every claim exactly as you would before sending analysis to a manager.

5. New words before we use them

Release QA = checks before publishing. Stale artifact = screenshot/file no longer matches analysis. Cardinality = allowed join matches. Reconciliation = independent agreement between routes. Secret = credential/token/password.

6. Watch / visual source

BOOK-LED. No external video is required. The learner book + PCH5_Publication_QA + named companion artifact fully teach this competency.

PCH5 - Follow with me once

7. Follow with me once - fully worked teacher demonstration

Rerun row counts, join/cardinality checks, key formulas/queries and one independent reconciliation. Then verify README numbers, screenshots, links and public-safety. A cosmetic pass cannot hide a numeric mismatch.

8. What you should see / be able to say

You can show the artifact, point to its evidence/validation path, explain what you personally did, and state one limitation without hiding behind a tutorial or generic claim.

9. Why it worked

The hiring artifact is tied to real course/project evidence, separates fact from claim, and can be inspected by another person. That converts competence into visible proof rather than self-description.

10. Common beginner mistakes

Only checking formatting; stale screenshot; README number differs from workbook; secret/API key left in notebook; join duplicates ignored.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

1) Name the artifact/claim. 2) Ask what evidence would prove it. 3) Open the exact workbook/repo/template. 4) Validate the earliest weak link. 5) Remove unsupported wording rather than decorating it. 6) Open protected review only after saving the attempt.

PCH5 - Do alone, validate and master

12. Now you do a small version alone

Run publication QA on another project and find at least one non-cosmetic issue.

13. Validate your result

Check truthfulness, evidence path, public-safety/privacy, working links/files, metric/technical correctness where applicable, and whether a reviewer can understand it without private explanation.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain what this artifact proves, what it does not prove, one choice you personally made, one validation check and the next improvement.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Save the PCH5 artifact first. If repair is needed, open the protected PCH5 review, diagnose the weak hiring-evidence competency, close it, then complete the changed task. Keep both attempts.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Save the completed PCH5_Publication_QA evidence row plus companion artifact/path. PASS -> PCH6. PARTIAL/FAIL -> targeted repair + changed retry before moving on.

PCH6 - Final capstone: independent end-to-end analyst work

Open exactly: PCH6_Capstone_Route in C1_M11_PORTFOLIO_CAPSTONE_HIRING_CANONICAL_PRACTICE_WORKBOOK_RC1.xlsx

1. Why this lesson matters

The capstone must be independent. The learner chooses the workflow and tools, preserves raw data, documents definitions, investigates injected data-quality issues, validates across at least two independent checks and defends the recommendation.

2. What you are learning

Complete an independent end-to-end analyst capstone and defend it.

3. What you already need / prerequisite

Prerequisite: PCH5 evidence plus relevant earlier course artifacts.

4. Picture it in your head

The capstone is your driving test. Nobody tells you which turn to take; the evaluator watches whether you preserve evidence, choose sensible methods, validate and make a defensible decision.

5. New words before we use them

Capstone = independent end-to-end assessment. Critical competency = area that must pass. Injected issue = deliberate data problem. Rubric = pass criteria. Causal boundary = limit on cause/effect claim.

6. Watch / visual source

BOOK-LED. No external video is required. The learner book + PCH6_Capstone_Route + named companion artifact fully teach this competency.

PCH6 - Follow with me once

7. Follow with me once - fully worked teacher demonstration

Before analysis, write decision and metric definitions. Preserve Orders_Raw. Log the five injected issue types, then choose documented treatment by metric. Join Products with explicit unmatched-key handling, run target/trend/segment analysis, validate two material metrics independently, then write findings/recommendation/limitations.

8. What you should see / be able to say

You can show the artifact, point to its evidence/validation path, explain what you personally did, and state one limitation without hiding behind a tutorial or generic claim.

9. Why it worked

The hiring artifact is tied to real course/project evidence, separates fact from claim, and can be inspected by another person. That converts competence into visible proof rather than self-description.

10. Common beginner mistakes

Following tutorial answer; silently deleting bad rows; ignoring unmatched Product_ID; wrong return denominator; claiming channel/delivery caused outcomes; recommendation unsupported.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

1) Name the artifact/claim. 2) Ask what evidence would prove it. 3) Open the exact workbook/repo/template. 4) Validate the earliest weak link. 5) Remove unsupported wording rather than decorating it. 6) Open protected review only after saving the attempt.

PCH6 - Do alone, validate and master

12. Now you do a small version alone

Defend MarketPulse against a changed reviewer challenge on denominator, join/grain and causality.

13. Validate your result

Check truthfulness, evidence path, public-safety/privacy, working links/files, metric/technical correctness where applicable, and whether a reviewer can understand it without private explanation.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain what this artifact proves, what it does not prove, one choice you personally made, one validation check and the next improvement.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Save the PCH6 artifact first. If repair is needed, open the protected PCH6 review, diagnose the weak hiring-evidence competency, close it, then complete the changed task. Keep both attempts.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Save the completed PCH6_Capstone_Route evidence row plus companion artifact/path. PASS -> PCH7. PARTIAL/FAIL -> targeted repair + changed retry before moving on.

PCH7 - Resume for a junior Data Analyst

Open exactly: PCH7_Resume_Audit in C1_M11_PORTFOLIO_CAPSTONE_HIRING_CANONICAL_PRACTICE_WORKBOOK_RC1.xlsx

1. Why this lesson matters

A junior resume should make evidence easy to scan: targeted headline/summary, relevant skills, 2-3 strong projects with quantified facts you can defend, education, and truthful experience/activities. Never invent work experience.

2. What you are learning

Build a truthful, ATS-readable junior Data Analyst resume.

3. What you already need / prerequisite

Prerequisite: PCH6 evidence plus relevant earlier course artifacts.

4. Picture it in your head

A resume is an index to evidence. Every skill/project line should point to something real you can open and defend. Empty keywords or invented experience create interview risk.

5. New words before we use them

ATS = applicant-tracking system. Tailoring = reorder truthful evidence to role. Claim = statement about skill/result. Quantified fact = number you can prove. Experience = actual work/activity, not course project unless labelled project.

6. Watch / visual source

ASSIGNED_VISUAL. Alex The Analyst - Create the Perfect Data Analyst Resume | Free Templates! | Full focused video. Why: Visual reinforcement for junior-analyst resume structure; final claims must remain truthful and evidence-backed. Internal fallback: PCH7 learner book + resume DOCX + checklist.

[Open 1](#)

PCH7 - Follow with me once

7. Follow with me once - fully worked teacher demonstration

Start with evidence, not adjectives. Put current truthful status/profile, relevant skills, 2-3 strong projects with defensible facts, education and only accurate additional items. Remove rating bars, fake experience and unsupported numbers.

8. What you should see / be able to say

You can show the artifact, point to its evidence/validation path, explain what you personally did, and state one limitation without hiding behind a tutorial or generic claim.

9. Why it worked

The hiring artifact is tied to real course/project evidence, separates fact from claim, and can be inspected by another person. That converts competence into visible proof rather than self-description.

10. Common beginner mistakes

Keyword dump; rating bars; invented employment; unprovable numbers; three-page fresher resume; projects described vaguely with no evidence.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

1) Name the artifact/claim. 2) Ask what evidence would prove it. 3) Open the exact workbook/repo/template. 4) Validate the earliest weak link. 5) Remove unsupported wording rather than decorating it. 6) Open protected review only after saving the attempt.

PCH7 - Do alone, validate and master

12. Now you do a small version alone

Tailor the same truthful resume evidence to a different junior role family without adding unsupported skills.

13. Validate your result

Check truthfulness, evidence path, public-safety/privacy, working links/files, metric/technical correctness where applicable, and whether a reviewer can understand it without private explanation.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain what this artifact proves, what it does not prove, one choice you personally made, one validation check and the next improvement.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Save the PCH7 artifact first. If repair is needed, open the protected PCH7 review, diagnose the weak hiring-evidence competency, close it, then complete the changed task. Keep both attempts.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Save the completed PCH7_Resume_Audit evidence row plus companion artifact/path. PASS -> PCH8. PARTIAL/FAIL -> targeted repair + changed retry before moving on.

PCH8 - LinkedIn / professional profile without overclaiming

Open exactly: PCH8_Profile_Audit in C1_M11_PORTFOLIO_CAPSTONE_HIRING_CANONICAL_PRACTICE_WORKBOOK_RC1.xlsx

1. Why this lesson matters

Your professional profile should match your resume and repositories. Use an accurate current status such as aspiring/junior analyst candidate when appropriate. Showcase projects and learning evidence without pretending a course project was employment.

2. What you are learning

Align LinkedIn/professional profile with resume and repositories without overclaiming.

3. What you already need / prerequisite

Prerequisite: PCH7 evidence plus relevant earlier course artifacts.

4. Picture it in your head

Your professional profile is the public front door. It must agree with your resume and repositories about who you are now, what you built, and what you are targeting.

5. New words before we use them

Headline = short professional positioning line. About = profile summary. Featured = highlighted projects/posts. Status = truthful current position. Consistency = resume/profile/repo details agree.

6. Watch / visual source

BOOK-LED. No external video is required. The learner book + PCH8_Profile_Audit + named companion artifact fully teach this competency.

PCH8 - Follow with me once

7. Follow with me once - fully worked teacher demonstration

Compare resume and profile line-by-line: current status, dates, skills, project names/links and descriptions. Pin/feature strongest working repositories. Rewrite any phrase that sounds like employment when it is actually course/project work.

8. What you should see / be able to say

You can show the artifact, point to its evidence/validation path, explain what you personally did, and state one limitation without hiding behind a tutorial or generic claim.

9. Why it worked

The hiring artifact is tied to real course/project evidence, separates fact from claim, and can be inspected by another person. That converts competence into visible proof rather than self-description.

10. Common beginner mistakes

Headline implies employment you do not have; dates differ from resume; course project called client work; featured repo broken; About full of unsupported tools.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

1) Name the artifact/claim. 2) Ask what evidence would prove it. 3) Open the exact workbook/repo/template. 4) Validate the earliest weak link. 5) Remove unsupported wording rather than decorating it. 6) Open protected review only after saving the attempt.

PCH8 - Do alone, validate and master

12. Now you do a small version alone

Write a changed truthful headline/About for another analyst role family while keeping resume/profile/repo consistency.

13. Validate your result

Check truthfulness, evidence path, public-safety/privacy, working links/files, metric/technical correctness where applicable, and whether a reviewer can understand it without private explanation.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain what this artifact proves, what it does not prove, one choice you personally made, one validation check and the next improvement.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Save the PCH8 artifact first. If repair is needed, open the protected PCH8 review, diagnose the weak hiring-evidence competency, close it, then complete the changed task. Keep both attempts.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Save the completed PCH8_Profile_Audit evidence row plus companion artifact/path. PASS -> PCH9. PARTIAL/FAIL -> targeted repair + changed retry before moving on.

PCH9 - Application strategy: targeted volume with evidence

Open exactly: PCH9_Application_Strategy in C1_M11_PORTFOLIO_CAPSTONE_HIRING_CANONICAL_PRACTICE_WORKBOOK_RC1.xlsx

1. Why this lesson matters

A healthy job search is a measurable funnel. Track role fit, evidence used, application date, stage, follow-up and rejection reason. Improve conversion by role family rather than sending identical applications everywhere.

2. What you are learning

Run a targeted application funnel and improve it from evidence.

3. What you already need / prerequisite

Prerequisite: PCH8 evidence plus relevant earlier course artifacts.

4. Picture it in your head

Job search is a funnel experiment, not a lottery. Track role fit, evidence used, stage and reasons; then change one input when conversion is weak.

5. New words before we use them

Funnel = applications -> screens -> interviews -> offers. Role fit = how well requirements match evidence. Reason code = structured rejection/outcome category. Follow-up = planned contact after application/interview.

6. Watch / visual source

BOOK-LED. No external video is required. The learner book + PCH9_Application_Strategy + named companion artifact fully teach this competency.

PCH9 - Follow with me once

7. Follow with me once - fully worked teacher demonstration

For one week, target roles with fit 3-5. Record resume version and project evidence used. At week's end compare screens/interviews/rejections by role family and change one evidence/resume/follow-up variable instead of just increasing volume.

8. What you should see / be able to say

You can show the artifact, point to its evidence/validation path, explain what you personally did, and state one limitation without hiding behind a tutorial or generic claim.

9. Why it worked

The hiring artifact is tied to real course/project evidence, separates fact from claim, and can be inspected by another person. That converts competence into visible proof rather than self-description.

10. Common beginner mistakes

Random volume only; same resume/project order for every role; no follow-up; no reason codes; stopping applications while polishing one project forever.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

1) Name the artifact/claim. 2) Ask what evidence would prove it. 3) Open the exact workbook/repo/template. 4) Validate the earliest weak link. 5) Remove unsupported wording rather than decorating it. 6) Open protected review only after saving the attempt.

PCH9 - Do alone, validate and master

12. Now you do a small version alone

Build a second role-family one-week application plan and state what evidence/resume order changes.

13. Validate your result

Check truthfulness, evidence path, public-safety/privacy, working links/files, metric/technical correctness where applicable, and whether a reviewer can understand it without private explanation.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain what this artifact proves, what it does not prove, one choice you personally made, one validation check and the next improvement.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Save the PCH9 artifact first. If repair is needed, open the protected PCH9 review, diagnose the weak hiring-evidence competency, close it, then complete the changed task. Keep both attempts.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Save the completed PCH9_Application_Strategy evidence row plus companion artifact/path. PASS -> PCH10. PARTIAL/FAIL -> targeted repair + changed retry before moving on.

PCH10 - Project walkthrough interview

Open exactly: PCH10_Project_Walkthrough in C1_M11_PORTFOLIO_CAPSTONE_HIRING_CANONICAL_PRACTICE_WORKBOOK_RC1.xlsx

1. Why this lesson matters

A strong walkthrough is a decision story. Explain why the metric and grain mattered, what broke or could have broken, how you validated, what the data supports, what it does not support, and what action you recommend.

2. What you are learning

Explain a project clearly in an interview with validation and limitation.

3. What you already need / prerequisite

Prerequisite: PCH9 evidence plus relevant earlier course artifacts.

4. Picture it in your head

A project walkthrough is a compressed evidence chain. In three minutes, take the interviewer from decision -> data/grain -> quality -> method -> validation -> findings -> recommendation -> limitation.

5. New words before we use them

Walkthrough = structured verbal project explanation. Pushback = interviewer challenge. Recovery = what you changed after a failure. Trade-off = choosing one approach over another for a reason.

6. Watch / visual source

BOOK-LED. No external video is required. The learner book + PCH10_Project_Walkthrough + named companion artifact fully teach this competency.

PCH10 - Follow with me once

7. Follow with me once - fully worked teacher demonstration

Time a three-minute walkthrough: 25s decision, 25s data/grain, 25s quality, 30s method, 25s validation, 25s findings, 15s recommendation, 10s limitation. Then answer one denominator and one causal pushback.

8. What you should see / be able to say

You can show the artifact, point to its evidence/validation path, explain what you personally did, and state one limitation without hiding behind a tutorial or generic claim.

9. Why it worked

The hiring artifact is tied to real course/project evidence, separates fact from claim, and can be inspected by another person. That converts competence into visible proof rather than self-description.

10. Common beginner mistakes

Spending two minutes on background; no grain/validation; reading README; hiding a failure; claiming cause from observational finding.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

1) Name the artifact/claim. 2) Ask what evidence would prove it. 3) Open the exact workbook/repo/template. 4) Validate the earliest weak link. 5) Remove unsupported wording rather than decorating it. 6) Open protected review only after saving the attempt.

PCH10 - Do alone, validate and master

12. Now you do a small version alone

Walk through a different project in three minutes and answer changed validation/limitation pushback.

13. Validate your result

Check truthfulness, evidence path, public-safety/privacy, working links/files, metric/technical correctness where applicable, and whether a reviewer can understand it without private explanation.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain what this artifact proves, what it does not prove, one choice you personally made, one validation check and the next improvement.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Save the PCH10 artifact first. If repair is needed, open the protected PCH10 review, diagnose the weak hiring-evidence competency, close it, then complete the changed task. Keep both attempts.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Save the completed PCH10_Project_Walkthrough evidence row plus companion artifact/path. PASS -> PCH11. PARTIAL/FAIL -> targeted repair + changed retry before moving on.

PCH11 - Technical interview preparation

Open exactly: PCH11_Technical_Interview in C1_M11_PORTFOLIO_CAPSTONE_HIRING_CANONICAL_PRACTICE_WORKBOOK_RC1.xlsx

1. Why this lesson matters

Technical interviews test reasoning under constraints. For every Excel/SQL/Power BI/Python/statistics answer, state the intended grain or definition, show the method, and include at least one validation check.

2. What you are learning

Prepare technical interviews through reasoning, validation and fresh drills.

3. What you already need / prerequisite

Prerequisite: PCH10 evidence plus relevant earlier course artifacts.

4. Picture it in your head

Technical interviews are live debugging of reasoning. The interviewer wants to see definitions, grain, method and validation—not just whether you memorized one SQL or DAX phrase.

5. New words before we use them

Technical drill = small reasoning problem. Validation check = test that could catch error. Error log = question -> mistake -> correct concept -> fresh retry. Constraint = condition the solution must respect.

6. Watch / visual source

ASSIGNED_VISUAL. Alex The Analyst - Data Analyst Interview Questions | Full focused video. Why: Interview-question visual after handbook drills; answer through reasoning and validation, not memorized scripts. Internal fallback: PCH11 learner book + interview handbook.

[Open 1](#)

PCH11 - Follow with me once

7. Follow with me once - fully worked teacher demonstration

Pick one SQL/Excel/BI/Python/stats mini-case. State grain/definition first, solve, validate and explain one failure mode. If wrong, log the error and create a changed retry rather than memorizing the answer.

8. What you should see / be able to say

You can show the artifact, point to its evidence/validation path, explain what you personally did, and state one limitation without hiding behind a tutorial or generic claim.

9. Why it worked

The hiring artifact is tied to real course/project evidence, separates fact from claim, and can be inspected by another person. That converts competence into visible proof rather than self-description.

10. Common beginner mistakes

Memorized answer with wrong denominator; syntax without grain; no NULL/join check; cannot explain own DAX/Python; collecting questions without fresh retry.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

1) Name the artifact/claim. 2) Ask what evidence would prove it. 3) Open the exact workbook/repo/template. 4) Validate the earliest weak link. 5) Remove unsupported wording rather than decorating it. 6) Open protected review only after saving the attempt.

PCH11 - Do alone, validate and master

12. Now you do a small version alone

Create two changed technical mini-cases from your latest weak topics and validate both.

13. Validate your result

Check truthfulness, evidence path, public-safety/privacy, working links/files, metric/technical correctness where applicable, and whether a reviewer can understand it without private explanation.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain what this artifact proves, what it does not prove, one choice you personally made, one validation check and the next improvement.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Save the PCH11 artifact first. If repair is needed, open the protected PCH11 review, diagnose the weak hiring-evidence competency, close it, then complete the changed task. Keep both attempts.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Save the completed PCH11_Technical_Interview evidence row plus companion artifact/path. PASS -> PCH12. PARTIAL/FAIL -> targeted repair + changed retry before moving on.

PCH12 - Behavioral questions and career-start narrative

Open exactly: PCH12_Behavioral in C1_M11_PORTFOLIO_CAPSTONE_HIRING_CANONICAL_PRACTICE_WORKBOOK_RC1.xlsx

1. Why this lesson matters

For behavioral answers, keep Situation/Task short and spend most time on Action, trade-offs, validation, communication and what changed. Fresher project/lab examples are valid if you clearly call them projects, not job experience.

2. What you are learning

Answer behavioral questions using truthful project-based STAR/CAR evidence.

3. What you already need / prerequisite

Prerequisite: PCH11 evidence plus relevant earlier course artifacts.

4. Picture it in your head

Behavioral answers are short case studies about your actions. Keep background brief and spend time on what you chose, built, checked, communicated and learned.

5. New words before we use them

STAR = Situation, Task, Action, Result. CAR = Challenge, Action, Result. Career-start narrative = truthful story of transition/current preparation. Trade-off = choice between competing needs.

6. Watch / visual source

OPTIONAL_VISUAL. Alex The Analyst - What To Say vs What NOT To Say | Full focused video. Why: Optional behavioral-answer comparison; project examples remain labelled projects. Internal fallback: PCH12 learner book + handbook STAR/CAR clinic.

[Open 1](#)

PCH12 - Follow with me once

7. Follow with me once - fully worked teacher demonstration

For 'a project did not work first time', keep situation/task under 20 seconds. Spend most time on your action: what failed, how you diagnosed/validated, what you changed, how you communicated and what you learned. Call it a project.

8. What you should see / be able to say

You can show the artifact, point to its evidence/validation path, explain what you personally did, and state one limitation without hiding behind a tutorial or generic claim.

9. Why it worked

The hiring artifact is tied to real course/project evidence, separates fact from claim, and can be inspected by another person. That converts competence into visible proof rather than self-description.

10. Common beginner mistakes

Long life story; 'we' instead of your action; fake workplace example; no validation/trade-off; result vague; memorized speech that does not answer question.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

1) Name the artifact/claim. 2) Ask what evidence would prove it. 3) Open the exact workbook/repo/template. 4) Validate the earliest weak link. 5) Remove unsupported wording rather than decorating it. 6) Open protected review only after saving the attempt.

PCH12 - Do alone, validate and master

12. Now you do a small version alone

Answer a changed conflict/failure/learning prompt using a project example without pretending it was employment.

13. Validate your result

Check truthfulness, evidence path, public-safety/privacy, working links/files, metric/technical correctness where applicable, and whether a reviewer can understand it without private explanation.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain what this artifact proves, what it does not prove, one choice you personally made, one validation check and the next improvement.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Save the PCH12 artifact first. If repair is needed, open the protected PCH12 review, diagnose the weak hiring-evidence competency, close it, then complete the changed task. Keep both attempts.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Save the completed PCH12_Behavioral evidence row plus companion artifact/path. PASS -> PCH13. PARTIAL/FAIL -> targeted repair + changed retry before moving on.

PCH13 - Offers, salary questions and professional negotiation

Open exactly: PCH13_Offer_Negotiation in C1_M11_PORTFOLIO_CAPSTONE_HIRING_CANONICAL_PRACTICE_WORKBOOK_RC1.xlsx

1. Why this lesson matters

Salary and offer conversations are professional decision problems. Research the actual role and market, understand the full offer, avoid invented competing offers, and negotiate only from facts and a range you would genuinely accept.

2. What you are learning

Handle salary/offer/logistics conversations professionally from real facts.

3. What you already need / prerequisite

Prerequisite: PCH12 evidence plus relevant earlier course artifacts.

4. Picture it in your head

An offer is a multi-variable decision. Salary matters, but so do role scope, learning, location, conditions and total compensation. Negotiation works best with real facts, not invented leverage.

5. New words before we use them

Budgeted range = employer's compensation range. Total compensation = salary plus other monetary benefits. BATNA = your real alternative, not invented. Acceptance criteria = conditions you genuinely require.

6. Watch / visual source

OPTIONAL_VISUAL. Alex The Analyst - Salary Negotiation | Full focused video. Why: Optional negotiation visual only after researching the actual role/company/location. Internal fallback: PCH13 learner book + offer clinic.

PCH13 - Follow with me once

7. Follow with me once - fully worked teacher demonstration

When asked salary, first understand role/location/scope and research the real market. You can ask for budgeted range. If you give a range, it must be one you can genuinely accept/justify. Never invent another offer.

8. What you should see / be able to say

You can show the artifact, point to its evidence/validation path, explain what you personally did, and state one limitation without hiding behind a tutorial or generic claim.

9. Why it worked

The hiring artifact is tied to real course/project evidence, separates fact from claim, and can be inspected by another person. That converts competence into visible proof rather than self-description.

10. Common beginner mistakes

Invented competing offer; quoting market number without role/location research; negotiating before understanding scope; stating a range you would not accept.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

1) Name the artifact/claim. 2) Ask what evidence would prove it. 3) Open the exact workbook/repo/template. 4) Validate the earliest weak link. 5) Remove unsupported wording rather than decorating it. 6) Open protected review only after saving the attempt.

PCH13 - Do alone, validate and master

12. Now you do a small version alone

Compare two changed truthful offer scenarios and list what must be clarified before negotiating/accepting.

13. Validate your result

Check truthfulness, evidence path, public-safety/privacy, working links/files, metric/technical correctness where applicable, and whether a reviewer can understand it without private explanation.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain what this artifact proves, what it does not prove, one choice you personally made, one validation check and the next improvement.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Save the PCH13 artifact first. If repair is needed, open the protected PCH13 review, diagnose the weak hiring-evidence competency, close it, then complete the changed task. Keep both attempts.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Save the completed PCH13_Offer_Negotiation evidence row plus companion artifact/path. PASS -> PCH14. PARTIAL/FAIL -> targeted repair + changed retry before moving on.

PCH14 - Final readiness and continuous improvement

Open exactly: PCH14_Readiness_Board in C1_M11_PORTFOLIO_CAPSTONE_HIRING_CANONICAL_PRACTICE_WORKBOOK_RC1.xlsx

1. Why this lesson matters

Job readiness is not a feeling. Maintain an evidence board for portfolio, resume/profile, technical drills, mock interviews and application funnel. Apply while improving; use interview errors to choose the next drill.

2. What you are learning

Use an evidence board to apply and improve continuously.

3. What you already need / prerequisite

Prerequisite: PCH13 evidence plus relevant earlier course artifacts.

4. Picture it in your head

Readiness is an evidence dashboard. Red areas become next week's drills while applications continue; you do not wait for a magical feeling of perfection.

5. New words before we use them

Readiness board = evidence status by competency. Critical weakness = gap likely to block hiring. Fresh drill = changed practice after failure. Continuous improvement = use real/mocked interview errors to choose next work.

6. Watch / visual source

BOOK-LED. No external video is required. The learner book + PCH14_Readiness_Board + named companion artifact fully teach this competency.

PCH14 - Follow with me once

7. Follow with me once - fully worked teacher demonstration

Create seven readiness rows: portfolio, capstone, resume/profile, technical drills, project walkthrough, behavioral, application funnel. Mark evidence status and one critical weakness. Schedule next week's fresh drill while applications continue.

8. What you should see / be able to say

You can show the artifact, point to its evidence/validation path, explain what you personally did, and state one limitation without hiding behind a tutorial or generic claim.

9. Why it worked

The hiring artifact is tied to real course/project evidence, separates fact from claim, and can be inspected by another person. That converts competence into visible proof rather than self-description.

10. Common beginner mistakes

Waiting for perfection; readiness based on confidence only; weak technical topic never retested; application funnel not reviewed; repeating same mistake.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

1) Name the artifact/claim. 2) Ask what evidence would prove it. 3) Open the exact workbook/repo/template. 4) Validate the earliest weak link. 5) Remove unsupported wording rather than decorating it. 6) Open protected review only after saving the attempt.

PCH14 - Do alone, validate and master

12. Now you do a small version alone

Use the latest mock/application evidence to build next week's changed improvement plan while applications continue.

13. Validate your result

Check truthfulness, evidence path, public-safety/privacy, working links/files, metric/technical correctness where applicable, and whether a reviewer can understand it without private explanation.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain what this artifact proves, what it does not prove, one choice you personally made, one validation check and the next improvement.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Save the PCH14 artifact first. If repair is needed, open the protected PCH14 review, diagnose the weak hiring-evidence competency, close it, then complete the changed task. Keep both attempts.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Save the completed PCH14_Readiness_Board evidence row plus companion artifact/path. PASS -> Gate A. PARTIAL/FAIL -> targeted repair + changed retry before moving on.

End-of-module readiness checklist

- Portfolio: 2-3 different projects; every skill/claim maps to evidence; repos are readable and public-safe.
- MarketPulse capstone: raw preserved; quality issues logged; definitions/grain explicit; unmatched key handled; two independent validations; 2-4 useful visuals; recommendation/limitations defensible.
- Resume/profile: truthful status, simple ATS-readable resume, working links, consistent dates/projects, no fake experience.
- Application funnel: role fit + evidence + resume version + stage + follow-up + reason code recorded.
- Project walkthrough: 3-minute decision story with data/grain, quality, method, validation, findings, recommendation and limitation.
- Technical prep: latest weak topics have changed retries; answers state grain/definition and validation.
- Behavioral: project examples labelled honestly; Action/validation/trade-offs specific.
- Offers/logistics: facts researched; no invented offer; acceptable criteria/range truthful.
- PCH14 evidence board is current and applications continue while weak areas are repaired.

Job Readiness Gate A

Attempt Gate A only after PCH14 is current. A clean pass ends M11 content competency.

Gate B/C are remediation-only; later whole-course Mentor/device QA is still separate.

Revision / hiring evidence quick reference

Portfolio	Proof categories > screenshot count.
Projects	Different business stories/methods; no tool stuffing.
Repo	README + data/grain + analysis + validation + reproduce + public-safe.
README	Decision -> data/grain -> quality -> method -> validation -> findings -> recommendation -> limits.
Capstone	Independent; preserve raw; investigate issues; 2 validations; causal discipline.
Resume	Truthful one-page where practical; evidence-backed skills/projects.
Profile	Matches resume/repositories; projects are not employment.
Applications	Track fit, evidence, stage, follow-up, reason; improve funnel.
Walkthrough	Decision -> grain -> quality -> method -> validation -> finding -> action -> limit.
Technical	Definition/grain -> method -> validation -> fresh retry.
Behavioral	Short context; specific Action; project examples labelled honestly.
Offer	Research facts; no fake leverage; evaluate role + location + compensation.
Readiness	Apply while improving; errors choose next drill.

Next route: PCH14 -> Job Readiness Gate A -> Course 1 Mentor synchronization after M11 pass.